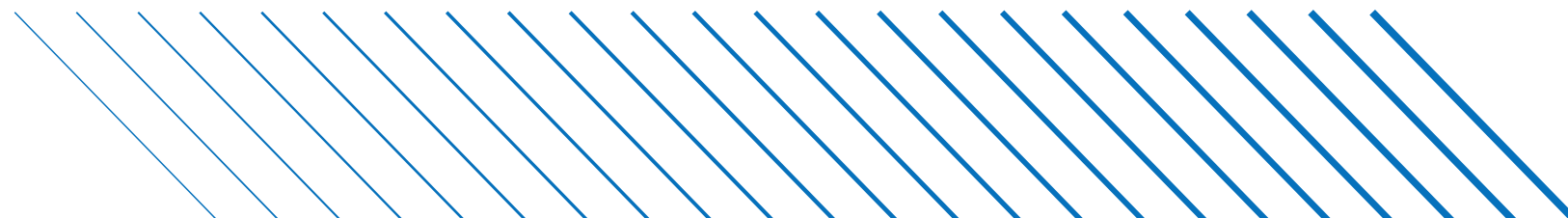
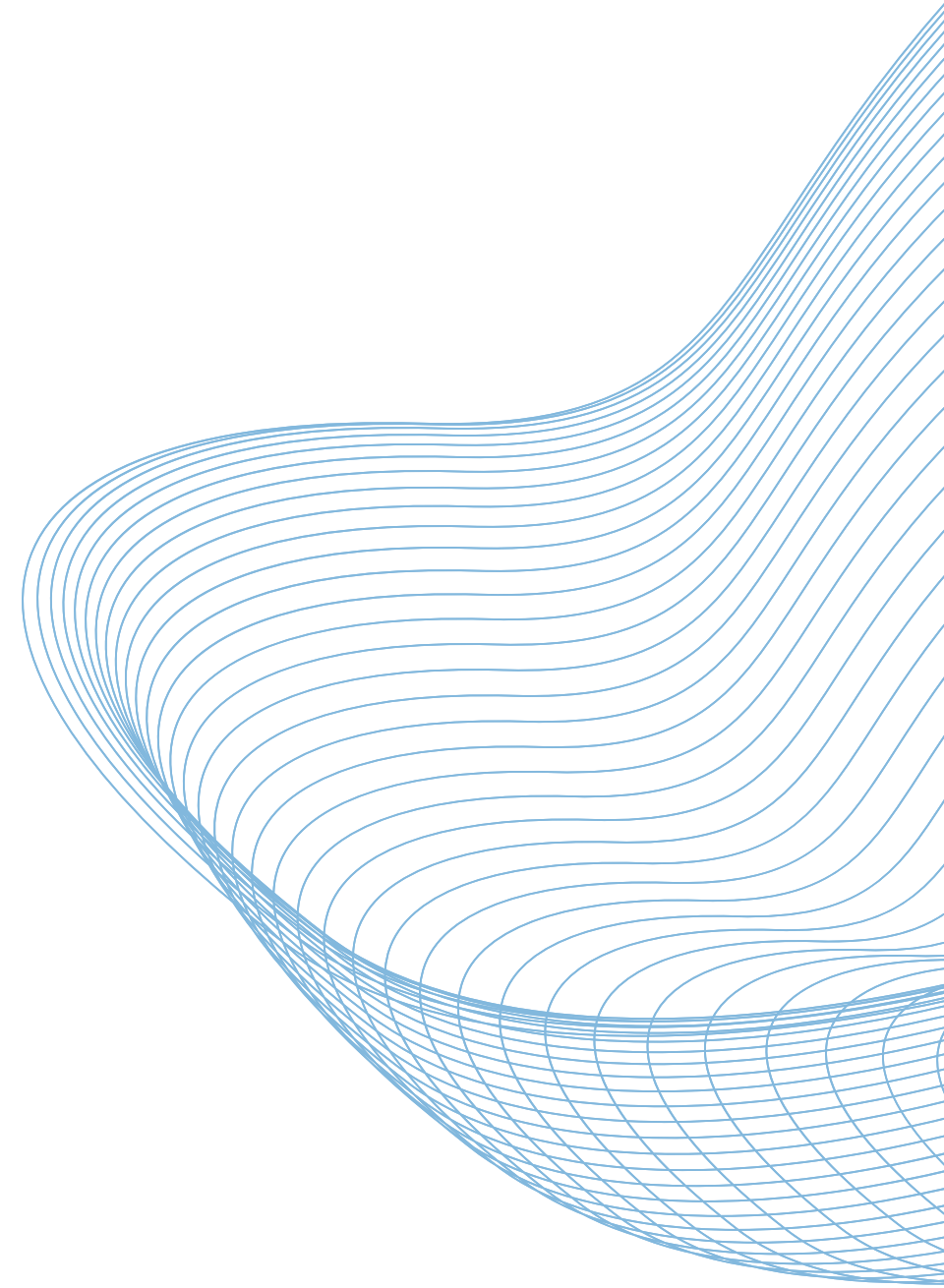


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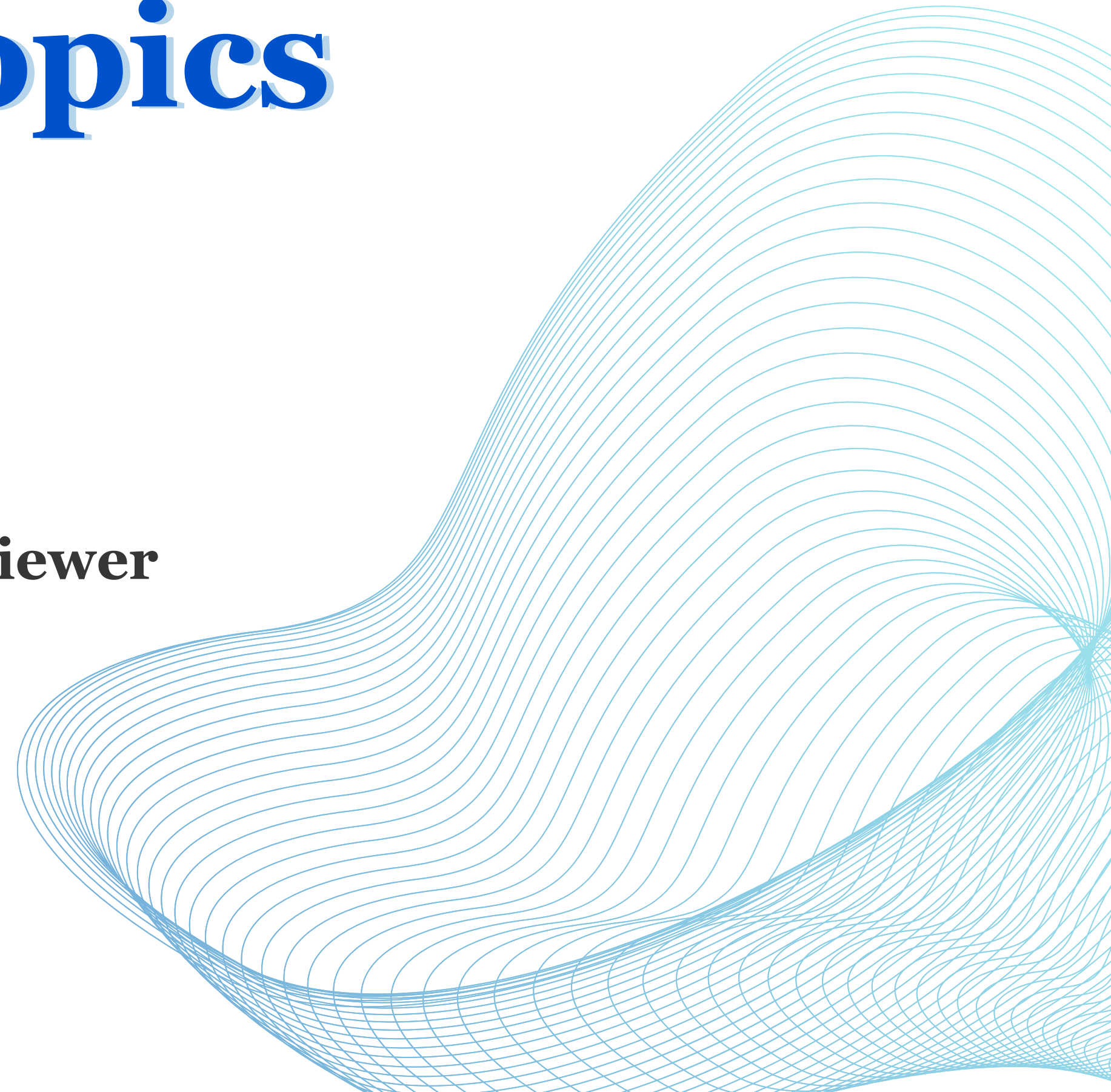
Behavioral Interview Training Session 1

Interview Principles



Overview of Topics

- **Interview Logic**
- **Interview Principles**
- **Guide to Become a Great Interviewer**





Interview Logic

Purpose of Job Interview (Employer's Perspective)

- 1. Assess the candidate's fit into the current position**
- 2. Assess the candidate's future growth potential and its value to me as an employer**
- 3. Assess the candidate's personal charm**

Interviews Formats

Technical Interview

Behavioral Interview

Purpose of Technical Interview

Technical Fit into the Position

- **Understand Candidate's Technical Experience Fit**
- **Understand Candidate's Technical Match**
 - **Compare Candidate's Technical Skill with Job Requirements**
- **Understand Candidate's General Problem Solving Ability**
 - **Systematic Thinking**
 - **Information Research and Analysis**
 - ...

Technical Skill Growth Potential

- **Understand the Boundary of Candidate's Technical Skill**
- **Understand Candidate's Ability to Apply Knowledge to Solve Unmet Problems**
- **Understand Candidate's Learning Ability**

Purpose of Behavioral Interview

Soft Skill & Quality Fit into the Position

- **Understand Candidate's Soft Skills**
 - **Leadership**
 - **Communication**
 - **Management**
- **Understand Candidate's Personal Quality**
 - **Motivation**
 - **Open-Minded**
 - **Resilient**
 - **Attention to Detail**
 - **Emotionally Stable/Stress Tolerance**
 - **Adaptability**

Career & Cultural Fit into the Position

- **Assess Candidate's Career Fit**
 - **Candidate's Career Development Plan Align with the Position's Career Path**
- **Assess Candidate's Cultural Fit**
 - **Fit Company's Culture & Team Dynamics**



Interview Principles

Be A Great Interviewer to Become An Excellent Interviewee

Be A Great Interviewer

Become An Excellent Interviewee



Guide to Become A Great Interviewer

Review: Purpose of Job Interview (Employer's Perspective)

- 1. Assess the candidate's fit into the current position**
- 2. Assess the candidate's future growth potential and its value to employer**
- 3. Assess the candidate's personal charm**



Guide to Become A Great Interviewer

Assess Candidate's Fit into the Current Position

The Approach to Assess Candidate's Fit into Current Position

1. Assess **education & relevant experience** (to predict success potential at this job)
2. Assess **technical skills** (depending on different industries & jobs)
3. Assess **soft skills and personal qualities** (from stories and communication style)
4. Assess **candidate's understanding of our company and job**
5. Assess **motivation** (guarantee success at this job)
6. Assess **cultural fit**
7. Assess **salary level and timeline match**

Assess Education & Relevant Experience

Assessment altitude:

1. Education experience & GPA (Relevant coursework)
2. Professional experience quality & duration
3. Transferable skills (from previous professional experience)

Example:

1. In your last internship, you analyzed portfolios and recommended investments to clients. Can you walk me through your thought process for analyzing the returns of a client portfolio?
2. You were an English major – how do you know you can handle the quantitative rigor required in investment banking?

Assess Technical Skills

Assessment Altitude (Take IB as Example)

1. Accounting
2. Enterprise/Equity Value
3. Valuation (DCF)
4. Merger Model
5. LBO Model

Example:

1. Why do we look at both Enterprise Value and Equity Value?
2. What is the angle formed by the hands of the clock when it is 1:45?
3. You have a hose along with a 3 liter bucket and a 5 liter bucket. How do you get exactly 4 liters of water?

Assess Soft Skills

Assessment altitude (according to job requirement):

- **Soft skills**

- **Leadership qualifications:** lead toward the vision, motivate teams, keep calm, build team dynamics, etc.
- **Management skills:** planning, decision making, organizing, staffing, etc.
- **Great communication skills:** guide discussions, maintain composure, objectivity, and open mindset when challenged
- Self-reflection
- Networking skills
- ...

Assess Personal Qualities

Assessment attitude (according to job requirement):

- **Personal quality**

- Take initiative and responsibility
- Ambitious & vision-driven
- Result oriented
- Optimism and resilience to go through challenges
- Creativity & solving problems through unconventional ways
- Highly disciplined & hardworking & high efficiency
- Stay calm anytime, especially under high pressure
- Open mindset & growth mindset
- Keep growing in skills, personal construction, and resources acquisition
- Reliable & trustworthy
- ...

Assess Soft Skills & Personal Qualities: Examples

Interview Question Examples:

1. What do you do for fun?
2. What are your favorite movies/books?
3. Tell me something interesting about you that's not listed on your resume
4. Tell me about a time when you failed to honor a commitment.
5. Let's imagine that your best friend is describing you in 3 words – which words would he/she use and why?
6. **Why would we decide not to give you an offer today?**

Assess Understanding of Company & Job

Assessment altitude:

1. Understanding of company mission, culture, etc.
2. How to deliver outstanding performance on this job

Example:

1. Why are you interested in our M&A division rather than our industry groups? Our Tech, Healthcare, and Energy teams have been really successful this year.
2. Since you worked at Bank of America this past year, you probably have the chance to go to a lot of different large banks – why are you interested in us specifically?

Assess Motivation

Assessment Altitude

1. Why finance? Why IB? Why company?
2. What motivates candidate to deliver high performance?

Example:

1. You've done Big 4 accounting for the past year – why would you want a job that's a lot more stressful with twice the hours?
2. You've had tons of engineering experience and you've worked at many tech companies. Why do you want to be an investment banker now?
3. Where else are you interviewing? Is it just banking? Consulting? Other companies?

Assess Cultural Fit

Assessment Altitude (usually combined with the understanding of company and personal quality questions):

1. Candidate's understanding of company culture
2. Do the candidate's personal qualities, soft skills and work style fit with the company culture?

Example:

1. Since you worked at Bank of America this past year, you probably have the chance to go to a lot of different large banks – why are you interested in us specifically? (also a why company question)
2. What are your favorite movies/books? (also a personal quality question)

Assess Salary & Timeline Match

Assessment Altitude (usually happens after the employer intends to hire a candidate):

1. Salary negotiation
2. Job start-date discussion

Example:

1. What's your expectation for your salary at this position?
2. What's the first day that you can start working at our company?



Guide to Become A Great Interviewer

**Assess Candidate's Future Growth Potential
and its Value to Employer**

The Approach to Assess Candidate's Future Growth Potential and its Value to Employer

- 1. Ambition & career plan (fit with company's interest?)**
- 2. Actively seek growth opportunity**
- 3. Possess good growth method & learning method & life-long learner**
- 4. Specific personal qualities**

Assess Ambition & Career Plan

Assessment altitude:

1. Is the candidate certain about his plan for the future? (can be uncertain only if he's still in college, otherwise better not)
2. Do the candidate's ambition and career plan fit the current industry and especially the company?

Example:

1. I realize it's still early in your career – you haven't even graduated yet – but have you given any thought to your long-term plans? Do you think you'll stick with investment banking?
2. What is your career goal?
3. Looking into the future 10 years, do you think you'll still be an investment banker?

Assess if Candidate Actively Seek Growth Opportunities

Assessment altitude:

1. Does the candidate always want to grow himself?
2. Is the candidate willing to take challenges, or even actively seek challenges to improve himself?
3. Can the candidate learn effectively from failure?
4. Is the candidate resilient and optimistic?

Example:

1. In your internship this past summer, what feedback did you receive?
2. What were a few areas that your team said you should try to improve upon?
3. What was your greatest failure?

Assess if Candidate Possess good growth method & learning method & life-long learner

Assessment altitude:

1. What's the candidate's theory of growth?
2. How does the candidate learn new skills?
3. Is the candidate a lifelong learner?
4. Is the candidate open-minded?

Example:

1. Tell me why we should hire you in 3 sentences?
2. How will you continue to thrive in the future?

Assess if Candidate Possess Specific Personal Qualities

Assessment altitude:

1. Does the candidate possess specific personal qualities that allow him to keep thriving in the future?

2. Personal quality examples:

- Resilient
- Optimistic
- Open-minded
- Goal-oriented
- ...

Example:

1. Tell me why we should hire you in 3 sentences?

2. Tell me about your strengths.



Guide to Become A Great Interviewer

Assess Candidate's Personal Charm

The Approach to Assess Candidate's Personal Charm

- 1. Can candidates build great personal connections with one or more of the interviewers?**
- 2. Can candidates demonstrate great leadership styles and communication styles?**
- 3. Do I want to work with them?**

Interviewers assess candidates on these aspects during their conversation, not based on the answer to a single question. Long-term training is necessary for interviewees to master great communication styles, leadership styles, and personal qualities to successfully impress interviewers



Homework

Define your ideal candidate as an interviewer, considering the following aspects:

1. Fit into the job position

- Education & relevant experience
- Technical skills
- Soft skills & personal qualities
- Understanding of company & job
- Motivation
- Culture fit
- Salary level & timeline match

2. Future growth potential & its value to employer

3. Personal charm



THE END